



Negotiation Tactics for Sales

Identify. Counter. Win — 25% more successful negotiations in 90 days.

Identify

Recognize buyer tactics early

Counter

Respond with confidence

Practice

Build repeatable skills

Why This Matters

Buyers come prepared. **Unchecked tactics cost you margin, control, and trust.**

- **Tactics erode margin**
Buyers engineer concessions through deliberate pressure
- **Control slips fast**
Reacting instead of leading puts you at a disadvantage
- **Relationships are at stake**
Strong counter-strategies protect long-term trust and renewals



Course Structure

Five focused modules — from awareness to measurable results.



Introduction to Tactics

Foundations and definitions



Identifying Common Tactics

Spot patterns before they cost you



Countering Techniques

Practical, repeatable responses



Role-Playing Scenarios

Live practice with real feedback



Measuring Success

Track and improve over time



Learning Objectives

By the end of this course, you will be able to:

Identify

Recognize common buyer negotiation tactics in real time

Counter

Apply practical, calm, question-based strategies

Practice

Build confidence through structured role-plays

Track

Measure improvement and close more deals

What Are Negotiation Tactics?

Deliberate behaviors designed to shift outcomes in the buyer's favor. Tactics are not the same as objections — they are calculated moves.



Healthy Tactics

Probing, anchoring, silence

Manipulative Tactics

False urgency, ultimatums, bad cop

Your Leverage Points

You have more power than you think. *Use it deliberately.*



Unique Value

Differentiation competitors can't match



Timing & Urgency

Renewals, deadlines, and budget cycles



Relationship Strength

Trust built over time is a real asset



Internal Champions

Allies who advocate on your behalf



The Classic Price Trap

What the Buyer Says

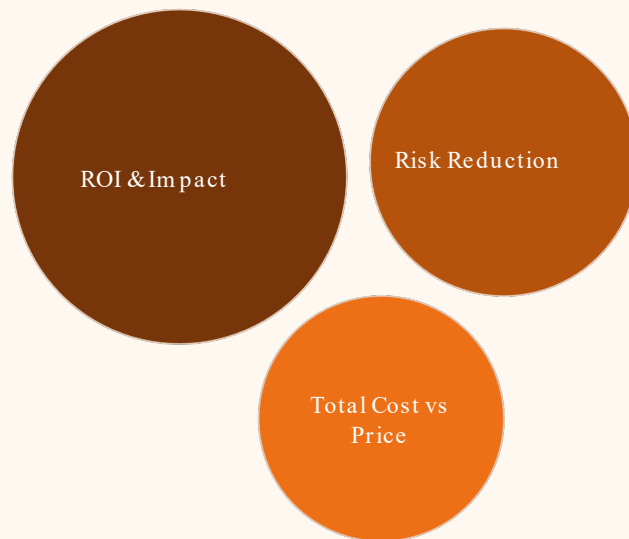
"We like you, but your price is too high."

Rep immediately discounts — no probing, no value reframe.

The Result

- Lower margin
- Weakened negotiating position
- Signal that discounting is always possible

What Was Missed



Discounting first is the most common and costly mistake in sales negotiations.

Reflect on Your Recent Deals

Think back — where did you feel pressure?

1

List 3 deals

Where you felt pressured or gave more than planned

2

What happened?

What exactly did the buyer say or do?

3

Your reaction

How did you respond — and what was the outcome?

4

Share one

Bring your best example to the group discussion



Identifying Common Tactics



Build Your Tactic Radar

Recognition is your first line of defense. Once you **name the tactic, you neutralize its power.**

Watch language

Specific phrases signal specific tactics

Track timing

When it happens in the deal matters

Read tone

Urgency, frustration, or passivity are all signals



Tactic #1: Price Anchoring

The buyer plants a **low reference point early** — before value is ever discussed. Everything after is judged against that anchor.

"Your competitor is 20% cheaper."



Watch for:

Competitor price drops in the opening minutes of a call — before you've established ROI or differentiation.

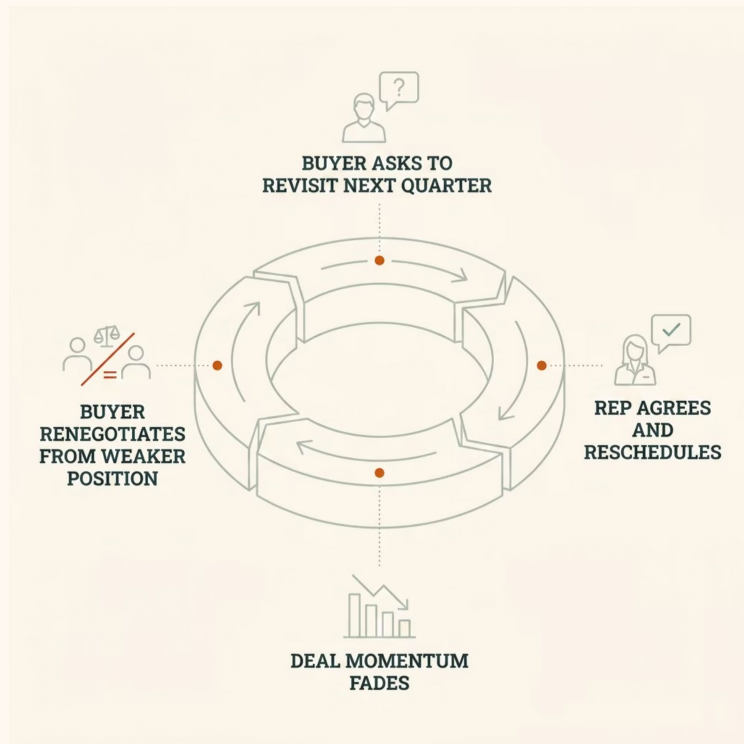
Signal

Price focus before value

Risk

You negotiate against yourself

Tactic #2: Stalling & Delay



The Delay Loop

Stalling is rarely about timing — it's about **shifting power**.

- "Let's revisit next quarter."
- Vague timelines, repeated reschedules
- No clear next step or decision criteria

❌ Pipeline bloat and lost momentum are the silent cost of unchallenged stalling.

Tactic #3: Good Cop / Bad Cop

A classic but effective play — one ally, one enforcer.

The Good Cop

Your sponsor. Supportive, encouraging. Creates emotional pull to "keep them happy."



The Bad Cop

Procurement or finance. Rigid demands, hard limits, often unseen.

The Risk

Over-conceding to preserve the "good" relationship — often more than necessary.





Tactic #4: Nibbling

Small asks at the finish line — framed as harmless, but **costly in aggregate**.

"Can you include training for free?
It's just a small thing."

When it happens

After price and terms are agreed — just before signing

The danger

Margin erosion and scope creep, deal by deal

Tactics #5 & #6: Ultimatums & Authority Shields

Take-It-or-Leave-It

| "This is our final offer."

Designed to end negotiation and force a binary choice.

- Creates artificial urgency
- Tests your resolve

Appeal to Authority

| "Finance will never approve this."

Shifts blame to an unseen, unreachable decision-maker.

- Removes accountability
- Leaves you arguing with a ghost

 **Risk:** Feeling cornered, rushed, and pressured to concede without full information.



Tactic - Spotting Exercise

Put your pattern recognition to work.



Review transcripts

Read sample emails and call summaries provided



Name the tactic

Identify which tactic each example represents



Spot the signals

What were the early warning signs?



Know your market

Capture the top 3 tactics most common in your deals

Countering Techniques



Shift from Reacting to Leading

Countering isn't confrontation — it's **calm**, **strategic redirection**.

→ Ask, don't argue

Questions reframe the conversation without escalating

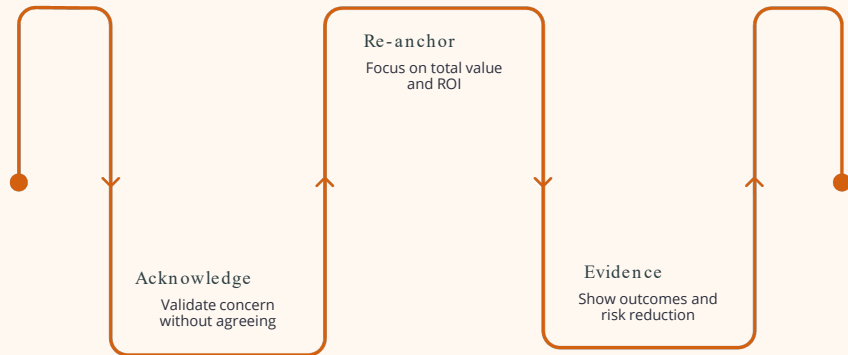
→ Protect value

Maintain rapport while defending your position

→ Flip the tactic

Turn buyer pressure into your leverage point

Countering Price Anchoring



What to Say

"I understand price is important. Let's look at total value — what this delivers versus what staying put costs you."

✓ **Key rule:** Never discount before you've re-established value. The first move is always a question or a reframe.

Bring in ROI

Tie your price to measurable business outcomes

Quantify risk

What does NOT choosing you cost them?

Avoid discounting first

Every early discount signals more is available

Countering Stalling & Delay

Unblock the Decision

"Help me understand what needs to happen before you can move forward."

Surface the real barrier — budget, approval, internal politics — and address it directly.



Pilot

Reduce commitment risk

Phased Rollout

Lower barrier to entry

Time-Bound Offer

Create legitimate urgency



Always close with a next step: A specific date, name, and action. Vague "follow-ups" invite more stalling.



Countering Good Cop / Bad Cop

SLIDE 19

Name the Dynamic

Acknowledge the tension without assigning blame. Naming the pattern neutralizes its power and resets the room.

Reframe the Conversation

"It sounds like you both have different concerns. Let's align on success criteria." — Redirect to shared outcomes.

Refocus on Business Outcomes

Shift the discussion away from positional conflict and toward the measurable value both sides want to achieve.

Keep Both Parties Engaged

Ensure neither stakeholder feels sidelined. Draw both into co-creating the solution so neither can play the villain.

Countering Nibbling

SLIDE 20

The Nibbling Trap

After a deal is nearly closed, the buyer requests small extras — discounts, add-ons, extended terms — betting you'll concede to protect the win.

Each small give erodes margin and sets a precedent for future deals.

Your Counter Playbook

→ Use Conditional Trades (If/Then)

"If we include that, then we'll need to adjust term or price." Every add has a cost — make it visible.

→ Summarize Agreed Scope

Before closing, recap exactly what was agreed. This anchors the deal and makes new asks feel like scope creep.

→ Protect Boundaries and Margin

Hold the line with confidence. Giving in to nibbles signals that your original offer had room — inviting more.



Countering Take -It-or-Leave-It & Authority Appeals

SLIDE 21

Test If "Final" Is Truly Final

Don't accept ultimatums at face value. Ask: *"Is there any flexibility to explore options that work for both sides?"* — Most "final" offers aren't.

Ask for Criteria and Access

When authority appeals arise, request the decision-maker's criteria directly. Understanding their constraints opens new paths forward.

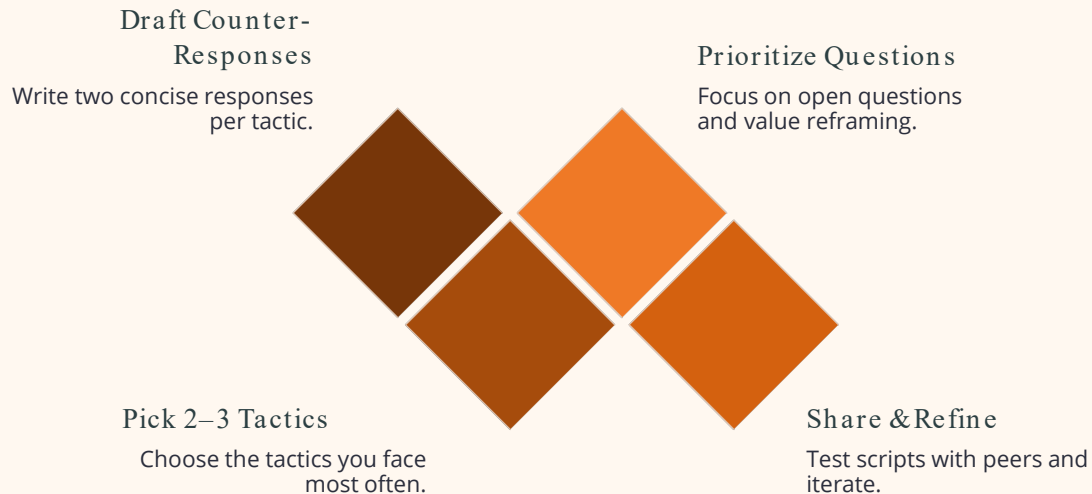
Co-Create the Business Case

Work alongside the decision-maker to build a case that justifies the investment internally. Make them the hero of the story.

Build - Your - Script Exercise

SLIDE 22

Turn theory into ready-to-use language. This exercise builds your personal counter-response library for the tactics you face most.



Focus on open questions and value re-framing — not defensive rebuttals. The best scripts sound natural, not rehearsed.

Advanced Counters, Role - Plays & Metrics

DECK 2 · SLIDES 19-34

Master the art of identifying and countering high-pressure negotiation tactics — then measure what winning actually looks like.



Module 4 – Role-Playing Scenarios

MODULE 4

Goal

Practice under realistic pressure — not in a vacuum. Simulated stress builds real-world resilience.

Combine Tactics

Each scenario layers multiple tactics simultaneously, mirroring how real buyers actually negotiate.

Build Composure

Strengthen your ability to stay calm, clear, and in control when pressure mounts mid-deal.

Muscle Memory

Move from knowing the theory to executing it instinctively — the goal of every rep.



Scenario 1 – Competitive Tech Deal

SLIDE 24

"Your competitor is cheaper, and we need a final answer by Friday."

Tactics in Play

- Price anchoring against a competitor
- Competitive pressure as leverage
- Artificial deadline to force urgency

Your Practice Tasks

01

Identify the Tactics

Name each tactic being used before responding. Awareness precedes action.

02

Re-Anchor on Value

Shift the conversation from price comparison to outcome differentiation.

03

Question the Deadline

Ask what's driving Friday. Unpack the urgency — it's often softer than stated.

04

Explore Decision Criteria

Understand what "cheaper" really means to them — total cost, risk, or speed?

Scenario 2 – Sponsor vs. Procurement

SLIDE 25

The sponsor champions your solution. Procurement pushes hard on price. Classic good cop / bad cop meets budget pressure.



Tactics in Play

Good cop / bad cop dynamic combined with an appeal to budget constraints — a powerful combination designed to isolate price as the only variable.



Your Task

Align both the sponsor and procurement around shared success metrics. Make the ROI case so compelling that price becomes secondary.



Practice Focus

Address budget concerns directly while protecting the value of your solution. Avoid discounting — reframe cost as investment with measurable return.

Scenario 3 – Late-Stage Nibbling

SLIDE 26

The Setup

You've received a verbal "yes." Then, one by one, extra asks begin to appear — additional users, extended support, faster delivery, a small price reduction. Each ask seems minor. Together, they erode the deal.



Late-stage nibbling is most dangerous because sellers are emotionally committed to closing and least likely to push back.

Tactics in Play

- Nibbling on agreed terms
- Subtle stalling to increase seller anxiety

Your Practice Tasks

- Use conditional trades to price every new ask
- Reset and restate the agreed scope clearly
- Hold margin with confidence and close decisively



Role-Play Structure

SLIDE 27

1

 Buyer

Uses assigned tactics from a card. Applies pressure naturally and realistically throughout the scenario.

2

 Seller

Must identify tactics in real time and deploy counter-strategies without breaking composure or rapport.

3

 Observer

Watches for control, clarity, and rapport. Provides structured feedback after each round using the debrief framework.

Rotate roles after each scenario so every participant experiences all three perspectives — buyer, seller, and coach.

Debrief Questions After Each Role - Play

SLIDE 28

Great debriefs accelerate learning faster than the role-play itself. Use these four questions to extract maximum insight from every round.

1

Which tactics did you notice first?

Awareness is the foundation. Identify what you caught early and what slipped past your radar.

2

Where did you gain or lose leverage?

Pinpoint the exact moments the dynamic shifted — and what caused the shift.

3

How effective were your counter-strategies?

Evaluate not just what you said, but how it landed. Did it redirect, defuse, or escalate?

4

What will you do differently next time?

Commit to one specific behavioral change you'll apply in your next real deal.



Module 5 – Measuring Negotiation Success

MODULE 5

Closing a deal is not the only measure of negotiation quality. True success means protecting margin, shortening cycles, and building repeatable skills.



Define Success

Go beyond "did we close?" — measure how you closed, at what margin, and with what speed.



Track Key Metrics

Tie negotiation quality to measurable KPIs that connect directly to revenue and deal health.



Use Data to Refine

Review patterns across your pipeline to identify where tactics cost you most — and coach accordingly.



25% Improvement Goal

Target a 25% increase in successful negotiations within 3 months of applying these frameworks.

Key Negotiation Metrics

SLIDE 30

These four metrics form the core scorecard for evaluating negotiation effectiveness across your team.

1

Close Rate

Compare close rate before vs. after training to measure the direct impact of skill development on win outcomes.

2

Avg. Discount Level

Track average discount percentage and deal margin to quantify how well sellers are protecting value under pressure.

3

Time-to-Close

Measure cycle length for heavily negotiated deals. Skilled counter-tactics reduce stalling and accelerate decisions.

4

Tactics Identified

Count deals where tactics were recognized and countered in real time — the leading indicator of negotiation mastery.

Negotiation Log Template

SLIDE 31

Consistent logging transforms individual deal experiences into team-wide intelligence. Use this template after every significant negotiation.

Deal Name & Stage	Tactics Encountered	Counter-Strategies Used	Outcome & Lessons	Next-Step Action
Deal name + current pipeline stage	List each tactic observed during the negotiation	What you said or did in response	Result achieved + what you'd do differently	One specific improvement to test next time
Example: Acme Corp — Proposal	Deadline pressure + nibbling	Questioned deadline; used If/Then trade	Closed at full price; could have re-anchored earlier	Open with value summary before price discussion

✔ Teams that log consistently identify tactic patterns 3x faster than those who rely on memory alone.



Real-World Application – Deal Review

SLIDE 32

1 Bring 2–3 Recent or Active Deals

Select deals where you felt pressure, faced unexpected tactics, or left value on the table. Real examples accelerate learning.

2 Log Tactics and Responses

Use the negotiation log template to document what happened, what you did, and what the outcome was for each deal.

3 Identify Patterns Across Your Pipeline

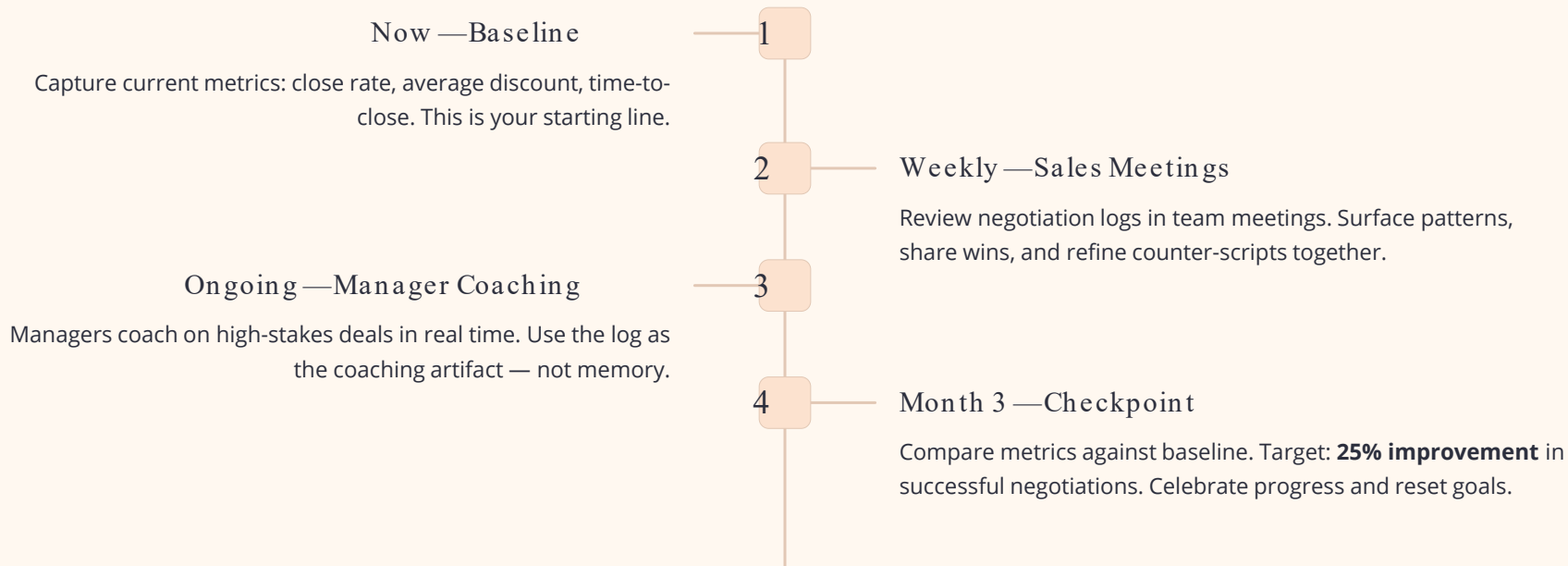
Look for recurring tactics — the same buyers often use the same playbook. Spotting patterns lets you prepare in advance.

4 Agree on 1–2 New Counter-Strategies to Test

Leave each review session with specific, committed actions — not general intentions. Name the deal, name the tactic, name the counter.

Success Metrics & 3-Month Plan

SLIDE 33



Target: 25% increase in successful negotiations within 3 months of consistent application and coaching.

Course Wrap - Up & Next Steps

SLIDE 34

Identify

Recognize tactics in real time — before they shift the dynamic. Awareness is your first and most powerful counter.

01

Commit to Negotiation Logs

Use the log template on every live deal starting this week. Consistency compounds over time.

Counter

Deploy the right response with confidence. Use questions, conditional trades, and value re-anchoring to protect margin and momentum.

02

Share Scripts and Wins

Build a team library of counter-scripts. What works for one seller can protect margin for the whole team.

Practice

Role-play, log, debrief, and repeat. Mastery comes from reps — not from reading slides.

03

Plan Your First Application

Name one deal, one tactic you expect to face, and one counter-strategy you'll use. Commit before you leave today.